For plumbers, HVAC, electricians, roofers, garage door and other trades

# The Google Review Request Playbook

A simple system you can start this week to get more Google reviews from real customers, every month, without being pushy.



Why reviews matter

# Reviews help you show up, and help people pick you.

For a local service business, Google reviews do three jobs at once. They help your ranking, they build trust before the phone rings, and they feed your Local Services Ads.

**Map Pack visibility**

Google ranks local results on relevance, distance and prominence. Prominence is partly based on how many reviews you have. Google says more reviews and positive ratings can help your local ranking.

**Trust**

Homeowners are letting you into their house. Reviews are how they decide if you're the one to call, often before they ever talk to you.

**Local Services Ads**

Google says star ratings and number of reviews affect how your business ranks in Local Services Ads. Your rating and review count are also shown right on the ad.

## What homeowners told BrightLocal in 2026

**97%**

of consumers read reviews for local businesses.

**47%**

won't use a business with fewer than 20 reviews.

**74%**

look for reviews written in the last three months. Fresh reviews matter, not just a big total.

**85%**

say positive reviews make them more likely to use a business.

**The takeaway: you need a steady flow of new reviews, not a one-time push.**

Sources: Google Business Profile Help, Tips to improve your local ranking: support.google.com/business/answer/7091 · Google Local Services Help, Reviews and Ratings on Local Services Ads: support.google.com/localservices/answer/7496631 · BrightLocal, Local Consumer Review Survey 2026 (1,002 US adults): brightlocal.com/research/local-consumer-review-survey

When to ask

# Ask when the good feeling is fresh.

Timing does most of the work. The best moment is when the customer can see the result and still remembers your tech's name.

Moment 1

## Right after the job is done

During the final walkthrough, when you show them the new water heater running, the panel labeled or the door opening smoothly. They've just seen the work with their own eyes.

Moment 2

## Right after they say thank you

"Thanks so much, you saved my weekend." That's your opening. A simple "That means a lot. Would you mind saying that on Google?" feels natural, not salesy.

Moment 3

## After you fix an urgent problem

No heat in January, a burst pipe or a garage door stuck with the car inside. Once the problem is solved and they've had a minute to breathe, relief turns into gratitude. Wait until things are calm, never mid-stress.

**One rule: ask every customer, the same way**

Make the ask part of every job, not just the ones that went perfectly. If a job was rough, fix the problem first, then send the same request you send everyone. Picking only happy customers breaks Google's rules (more on page 10).

How to ask in person

# Three short scripts for your techs.

Keep it short and low-pressure. The goal is to plant the seed on site, then let the text do the rest. Techs can pick whichever sounds most like them.

The walkthrough

"You're all set. We're a local company, and Google reviews are a big part of how people find us. I'll send you a quick text with the link. If you have a minute later, we'd really appreciate it."

After a thank-you

"I'm glad we could help. If you'd be willing to share how it went on Google, it makes a real difference for a small business like ours. Here's a card with a code you can scan whenever it's convenient."

After an urgent fix

"Glad we got that sorted tonight. No rush at all, but when things settle down, an honest review on Google helps other folks in your spot find us. I'll text you the link."

**Do**

- Ask for an honest review, every time.
- Tell them a text with the link is coming.
- Leave a card with your QR code.

**Don't**

- Stand there while they write it.
- Ask for five stars or tell them what to say.
- Ask them to mention a tech by name.

Google's review policy says businesses shouldn't pressure customers to leave reviews on site or ask for specific content, including content that names a staff member: support.google.com/contributionpolicy/answer/7400114

Text templates

# Three texts. Then stop.

Most people mean to leave a review and simply forget. A friendly reminder sequence fixes that. Each text below stays under 300 characters, even with a real review link and a long name filled in.

Text 1 · Same day, within a few hours of the job

Hi [First name], it's [Tech] with [Company]. Thanks for having us out today. If you have a minute, would you share how it went on Google? It helps a local business like ours a lot: [review link] Reply STOP to opt out.

About 217 characters before the link is filled in

Text 2 · Two days later, if no review yet

Hi [First name], checking in after your [service] on [day]. Is everything still working well? If anything's off, just reply here. And if you have a moment, an honest Google review would mean a lot: [review link]

About 211 characters before the link is filled in

Text 3 · Five days after the job, final nudge

Hi [First name], last note from us on this. If you have 30 seconds, we'd be grateful for a quick Google review: [review link] Either way, thanks for choosing [Company]. We're here if you need us.

About 195 characters before the link is filled in

**Good to know:** Only text customers who gave you their number for the job. Stop the sequence as soon as they leave a review or reply STOP. Every customer gets the same link, even the ones who reply with a complaint.

Email templates

# The same three steps, by email.

Use email for customers who prefer it, or send it alongside the text. Keep it short enough to read on a phone.

Email 1 · Same day

**Subject: Thanks from [Company]**

Hi [First name],

Thanks for having us out today for your [service]. We're a local team, and reviews on Google are one of the main ways new customers find us.

If you have a minute, we'd appreciate an honest review here: **[review link]**

Thanks again,
[Your name], [Company]

Email 2 · Two days later

**Subject: How's everything working?**

Hi [First name], just checking that your [service] is still working the way it should. If anything's off, reply to this email and we'll take care of it.

And if you have a moment, an honest Google review would mean a lot: **[review link]**

Email 3 · Five days after the job

**Subject: One last quick favor**

Hi [First name], last note from us on this. If you have 30 seconds, we'd be grateful for a quick review: **[review link]**. Either way, thank you for choosing [Company]. Save this email in case you ever need us again.

Making it easy

# One tap or one scan. That's it.

Every extra step loses people. Don't make customers search for your business. Send them straight to the review form with your direct Google link or a QR code.

Get your link and QR code

1. On a computer, search your business name on Google while signed in as the profile's owner or manager.
2. Select **Read reviews**, then **Get more reviews**.
3. Click **Copy** to grab your review link.
4. Right-click the QR code and choose **Save image as**. Google only creates review QR codes in a computer browser, not on a phone.

Where to put it

- Every text and email in this guide
- Invoices and receipts, printed and emailed
- A small leave-behind card your tech hands over
- A sticker on the equipment you installed
- Your email signature

**Before you print**

Scan the code with two different phones to make sure it opens your review form. Pull a fresh link from your profile before each print run.

## Sample leave-behind card

Your Google review QR code

### Thanks for choosing [Company].

How did we do? Scan to leave an honest review on Google. It takes about a minute and helps your neighbors find a local pro they can trust.

Source: Google Business Profile Help, Create a Google link or QR code to request reviews: support.google.com/business/answer/16816815

Handling negative reviews

# Stay calm. You're writing for the next customer.

A bad review stings. But the person you're really answering is the homeowner reading it next month. A calm, fair reply can say more about you than the review does.

The calm reply framework

1. **Wait, then reply within a day or two**
   Don't answer angry. Sleep on it if you need to, but don't let it sit for weeks.
2. **Thank them and name the issue**
   Show you read it. Use their name and the specific problem they raised.
3. **Own what's yours, and only that**
   Apologize where you fell short. Don't argue, don't blame, and never share job details or private info.
4. **Take it offline with a real next step**
   Give a name and a direct number so they can reach someone who can fix it.
5. **Keep it short and sign it**
   A few sentences is plenty. Sign with your name so it reads like a person, not a company.

Example reply

"Hi Dana, thank you for letting us know. You're right that we were late for your window, and I'm sorry we didn't call ahead. That's not how we want to treat anyone. I'd like to make this right. Please call me directly at [phone]. – Sam, Owner"

**Never** offer money or a discount to remove or change a review, and never threaten a reviewer. If a review looks fake or breaks Google's rules, report it from your Business Profile instead.

Sources: Google Business Profile Help, Tips to get more reviews (replying to negative reviews): support.google.com/business/answer/3474122 · FTC, Consumer Reviews and Testimonials Rule Q&A: ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/consumer-reviews-testimonials-rule-questions-answers

Responding to every review

# Reply to every review. Make each one sound human.

Replying shows people a real business is paying attention. In BrightLocal's 2026 survey, 80% of consumers said they're likely to use a business that responds to all of its reviews.

Positive reply template

"Thanks, [First name]. [One specific detail from their review or the job.] We appreciate you trusting [Company] with your [service]. [Short, friendly close.] – [Your name]"

## Two filled-in examples

Water heater install

"Thanks, Chris. Glad the new tankless unit has you covered for hot showers again. We appreciate you trusting us with the install. Enjoy the endless hot water. – Sam"

Garage door repair

"Thanks, Maria. A broken spring on a Saturday morning is no fun, and we're glad we could get you back out the door. Thanks for calling us. – Sam"

**Quick rules for positive replies**

- Add one real detail. Don't paste the same "Thanks for the review" on every one.
- Keep it to two or three sentences.
- Skip the sales pitch. No coupons or promos in replies.
- Set a time each week, like Friday at 4 p.m., to reply to everything new.

Sources: BrightLocal, Local Consumer Review Survey 2026: brightlocal.com/research/local-consumer-review-survey · Google Business Profile Help, Tips to get more reviews: support.google.com/business/answer/3474122

Staying compliant

# Play it straight. Shortcuts can cost you.

Google can remove reviews that break its rules. The FTC can also go after businesses for fake or bought reviews. The simple version: ask everyone, honestly, and never pay for it.

**No incentives**

No discounts, gift cards, raffle entries or free service in exchange for a review. Google strictly prohibits it. The FTC's rule also bans any reward tied to a positive (or negative) review, even if it's only implied.

**No gating or filtering**

Don't send only your happy customers to Google, or use a "rate us first" screen that routes unhappy people to a private form. Google doesn't allow businesses to selectively ask for positive reviews or discourage negative ones.

**No pressure, quotas or scripts**

Don't pressure customers on site or tell them what to write. Don't give techs a review quota. Google's policy calls out both.

**No fake or insider reviews**

No reviews from employees, family or friends posing as customers, and no reviews from anyone who didn't actually use your service.

This page is a plain-language summary, not legal advice. Read Google's full policy and talk to your attorney if you're unsure.

Sources: Google Maps, Prohibited & restricted content: support.google.com/contributionpolicy/answer/7400114 · FTC, Final rule banning fake reviews and testimonials: ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2024/08/federal-trade-commission-announces-final-rule-banning-fake-reviews-testimonials

The one-page checklist

# Your review system, on one page.

Print this and pin it up in the office. Set it up once, then run the same steps on every job.

### Set up once

- [ ] Copy your Google review link
- [ ] Download your review QR code from a computer
- [ ] Test the link and code on two phones
- [ ] Add the QR code to invoices and receipts
- [ ] Print leave-behind cards for every truck
- [ ] Load the three texts and emails into your phone or CRM
- [ ] Decide who sends the texts and replies to reviews

### Every job

- [ ] Tech asks during the walkthrough
- [ ] Tech leaves the QR card
- [ ] Text 1 goes out the same day
- [ ] Text 2 goes out two days later if there's no review
- [ ] Text 3 goes out five days after the job, then stop
- [ ] Stop right away if they review or reply STOP

### Every week

- [ ] Reply to every new review
- [ ] Answer negative reviews within one or two days
- [ ] Move unhappy customers to a phone call
- [ ] Count new reviews this week compared with last week

### Never

- ◯ Offer anything in exchange for a review
- ◯ Ask only the happy customers
- ◯ Ask for five stars or specific wording
- ◯ Give techs review quotas
- ◯ Post fake or employee reviews

From Kickbord

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